

Research ethics approval number: 17492

Social norm change experiments

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and feel free to email us if you would like more information or if there is anything that you do not understand. We would like to stress that you do not have to accept this invitation and should only agree to take part if you want to. Thank you for reading this.

Background

In this research, we are testing some aspects of what affects people's decision making in groups.

The study and what will happen if I take part?

We will ask you to provide some demographic information, including your age and gender using a secure online form, before taking part in the study. This information will be stored in a secure server at the university. During the study, using our online platform, we will ask you to make a decision on something. You will be part of a group of participants who will be doing the same task as you at the same time, also making their own decisions. You will see the decisions that they all make, and they will see the decision you make. You will then be asked to decide again until everyone in the group has agreed on a consensus. No identifying information will be collected beyond your age and gender, which will not be shared with other participants or anyone else, and only the data you input on the platform will be recorded. The experiment and questions should take no longer than 45 minutes.

Experiment participants simply need to be English-speaking adults over the age of 18.

Do I have to take part?

No, participation is voluntary. You are free to withdraw your participation at any time, including during the experiment, without explanation, and without incurring a disadvantage. If you wish to withdraw permission to use your responses during the experiment, simply close the web-window

How will my data be used?

The University processes personal data as part of its research and teaching activities in accordance with the lawful basis of 'public task', and in accordance with the University's purpose of "advancing education, learning and research for the public benefit.

Under UK data protection legislation, the University acts as the Data Controller for personal data collected as part of the University's research. The Principal Investigator acts as the Data

Processor for this study, and any queries relating to the handling of your personal data can be sent to Dr Mark Pogson (Mark.Pogson@liverpool.ac.uk).

Will I be identifiable from my data?

No identifying information will be collected beyond your gender and age. Any information you potentially give as part of the experiment (i.e. by entering it into the sign-up form, emailing it to us, or by typing it into the platform) which may identify you in your responses will be removed.

Further information on how your data will be used can be found in the table below.

How will my data be collected?	Data will be collected via our securely-hosted web platform before being stored on a password-protected server.
How will my data be stored?	Data input will be transferred immediately to a secure, password-protected server as soon as it is submitted.
How long will my data be stored for?	Data (with no identifying information) will be stored indefinitely on a public server (Open Science Framework) to allow the research community to use the data.
What measures are in place to protect the security and confidentiality of my data?	All data will be stored on a secure, password-protected server. Data will only be accessible by the research team (the principal investigator, co-investigator and the research assistant) until it is checked for identifying information.
Will my data be anonymised?	Yes, we will not collect any identifying information from you except your age and gender. If you provide this information yourself as part of your responses, this will be removed.
How will my data be used?	Data will be used in written reports and conference presentations. Your experimental responses will be reported in an aggregated way in these written reports.
Who will have access to my data?	Only the principal investigator, co-investigator and the research assistant until the data is processed, and then it will be made publicly available.
Will my data be archived for use in other research projects in the future?	Yes, the responses will be archived and so may be used in other research studies in the future.
How will my data be destroyed?	Any data with identifying features will be destroyed by deleting the original data once it has been processed.

Will I be remunerated for my time?

Yes, experimental participants will be paid a £10 voucher for their time.

Are there any benefits in taking part?

Participants will be contributing to improving our knowledge of how social norms change.

Are there any risks in taking part?

There are no known severe risks in relation to participating in these experiments. An internet connection may potentially fail or participants could also potentially experience discomfort while answering questions, though none of the questions knowingly relate to sensitive subject-matter. If any participant experiences discomfort or disadvantage as part of the research, they should make the principal investigator (Dr Mark Pogson) aware immediately.

What will happen to the results of the study?

The results of this work will be disseminated to communication professionals, as well as to more traditional academic audiences via conferences and journals.

What will happen if I want to stop taking part?

You can withdraw your participation in the study at any time, without explanation. Withdrawal will not be possible after the end of the experiment.

What if I am unhappy or if there is a problem?

If you are unhappy, or if there is a problem, please feel free to let us know by contacting Dr Mark Pogson (Group.Experiment@liverpool.ac.uk) and we will try to help. If you remain unhappy or have a complaint which you feel you cannot come to us with then you should contact the Research Ethics and Integrity Office at ethics@liv.ac.uk. When contacting the Research Ethics and Integrity Office, please provide details of the name or description of the study (so that it can be identified), the researcher(s) involved, and the details of the complaint you wish to make.

The University strives to maintain the highest standards of rigour in the processing of your data. However, if you have any concerns about the way in which the University processes your personal data, it is important that you are aware of your right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office by calling 0303 123 1113.

Who can I contact if I have further questions?

Any queries should be directed to the principal investigator:

Dr Mark Pogson

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